Model Group Discussion (5 participants)

A Model Group Discussion 1

(5 participants)

Examiner

Ladies and gentlemen, you have assembled here for a lively discussion. You are all young and at one time or other you will each choose a life partner. What will you do? Would you prefer a marriage of your choice or one arranged by your parents? You are at liberty to speak on any one of the two alternatives.

4th Speaker

Thank you, madam, for giving us an interesting topic for discussion. Friends, I would like to speak in favour of one's own choice in marriage. There was a time when people depended entirely on marriage brokers, who had a list of marriageable sons and daughters with all their horoscopes. Marriage negotiations were on the basis of caste and dowry. Now things have changed in many cases. Marriages based on choice have become very common. It is the result of

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an understanding between two partners. As love is a strong binding force here, it is bound to succeed. One doesn't normally find discord between the partners....

5th Speaker

Sorry to interrupt you. I don't agree with you. I have come across a number of cases of divorce even in marriages of choice. Young men and women lack worldly experience. Their emotions and passions govern them. My friend speaks of love that binds young people. No, it is actually blind passions that govern them. Marrage is a crucial decision. Any wrong step will ruin the lives of the couple. Love is blind. The young consider only love and nothing else. They are not concerned with family background, their future, or commitment. This is bound to present problems in later life.

3rd Speaker

I fully agree with speaker 5. Young people are hasty in their decisions. Parents, on the other hand, are our well-wishers. They take into consideration all aspects before they arrange the marriage of their children. They would like to see their children settled happily. Such marriages are always successful. The partners lead a peaceful married life without stress or tension.

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1st Speaker

I am unable to understand how you can be so sure of the success of such marriages. Considerations of money, position, prestige and purity of caste always mislead parents. They are not concerned with the personality of the bridegroom, his attitude or his nature. It is compatibility of temperament that matters. The man and woman interact with each other for a few months, understand each other's temperament, likes and dislikes, and when they finally settle down to a married life, they are bound to be happy. In marriages arranged by parents, the couples are miserable throughout their lives.

2nd Speaker

I agree with speaker 1. Parents place emphasis on money, occupation and prestige but attach no importance to individual merits and traits. There is no charm in such a dull life. Therefore, marriages of choice are better.

5th Speaker

Our friends do not realise that marriages of choice are actually the influence of western culture. The main purpose of life is to lead a peaceful and happy life. Generations and generations of Indians have believed in marriages arranged by parents. Our parents, grandparents and great grandparents – all had such marriages. They led an extremely happy life. You can't say that about marriages of one's own choice, most of which end in disappointment, divorce, suicide and even murder.

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2nd Speaker

Our friend has used extremely harsh words. If marriages of choice fail, it is only because of the interference of the parents on both sides. They can't reconcile themselves to their children going against their wishes. They try to separate the couple. In marriages of choice, young people have to depend only on themselves. Parents don't support them. There is more interdependence between husband and wife, which is really good for the smooth functioning of the family.

3rd Speaker

I don't agree with the previous speaker that parents conspire against their own children. Parents are known for their spirit of tolerance. Parents are attached to their children. Even if parents are concerned with money, who do they require it for? Not for themselves, but for their children. It is also wrong to believe that parents are not concerned about the bride or bridegroom. Love is the only determining factor for young people, but parents look at marriage from different angles. Many factors are involved in their choice of a bride or bridegroom. I again emphasise that a marriage arranged by parents is certainly better than a marriage of choice. Yes, parents are concerned about the financial status of their son-in-law or daughter-in-law, but only because they want their children to be happy.

Examiner

Well, ladies and gentlemen, it is time to wind up the discussion. Thank you very much for your active participation.